



“Skill in
discourse should
be a part of ...
**a woman’s
moral
repertoire ...**”

CHRISTINE DE PIZAN, *THE BOOK OF THE TREASURY OF LADIES*, 1405

CHALLENGING MISOGYNY

The French-Italian writer Christine de Pizan was Europe’s first professional female author, and is considered to have written some of the earliest pieces of feminist literature. She began by writing love ballads, which attracted the attention of wealthy patrons including Isabella of Bavaria, the queen of France (shown, left, receiving a manuscript of Pizan’s works). Pizan, who believed that she had been chosen by God to challenge the misogyny of the French court, published her popular *The Book of the City of Ladies* in 1404-1405, and *The Book of the Treasury of Ladies*, an education manual, in 1405. Her works presented women in a positive light and denounced her male contemporaries for their sexist treatment of women implicit in their writing.